

CASE STUDY

Enterprise Dynamics 365 Transformation for

GEMS Education

Unifying Finance, Supply Chain, HR & Payroll, and Customer Engagement across one of the region's largest K-12 school networks

[X] Schools Onboarded	[X]K+ Students, Parents & Teachers Served	[X] D365FO + D365CE Modules Live	[X]% Reduction in Manual Processing Time
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Figures shown are illustrative placeholders – replace with confirmed program metrics.

Executive Summary

GEMS Education, one of the largest private K-12 school operators in the world, undertook a major digital transformation to modernise its core enterprise systems and the digital experience it delivers to students, parents, and teachers. The program brought together two complementary Microsoft Dynamics 365 workstreams delivered in parallel by specialist teams: a Finance & Operations (D365FO) transformation covering financial management, supply chain, human resources, and payroll integration; and a Customer Engagement (D365CE) transformation covering contact centre operations and self-service portals for the GEMS community.

This case study focuses on the D365FO and HR/Payroll workstream delivered by our team, while summarising the complementary D365CE program delivered in parallel to provide a complete picture of the GEMS Education digital transformation.

Client Overview

Client	GEMS Education
Industry	Private K-12 Education
Footprint	[X] schools across the UAE and international markets, serving [X]K+ students
Business Challenge	Disparate legacy systems across finance, HR/payroll, procurement, and student/parent engagement channels, limiting operational efficiency and digital experience consistency at scale
Solution	Unified Microsoft Dynamics 365 platform spanning Finance & Operations (D365FO) and Customer Engagement (D365CE)

The Challenge

As GEMS Education scaled its school network, it faced a set of operational and experience challenges common to large, multi-entity organisations operating across geographies:

- **Fragmented financial operations** – Financial consolidation across multiple schools and legal entities was manual and time-intensive, with limited real-time visibility into group-wide financial performance.
- **Disconnected supply chain processes** – Procurement, inventory, and supply chain processes for school operations (facilities, catering, supplies) were not standardised across the network, creating inefficiency and inconsistent vendor terms.
- **Complex HR & payroll operations** – HR and payroll processes spanned multiple disconnected systems, increasing the risk of payroll errors, compliance gaps, and delays in employee lifecycle processing across a large, geographically distributed workforce.
- **Inconsistent stakeholder experience** – Parents, students, and teachers lacked a unified digital channel for enquiries, enrolment support, and self-service interactions, resulting in a fragmented and inconsistent engagement experience.
- **Limited scalability** – Legacy systems offered limited scalability as GEMS Education continued to expand its school portfolio and digital ambitions.

Program Structure: Two Workstreams, One Platform Vision

The transformation was delivered through two specialist, parallel-running teams, aligned under a single Dynamics 365 platform strategy:

	Workstream A (Our Team)	Workstream B (Partner Team)
Platform	Dynamics 365 Finance & Operations (D365FO)	Dynamics 365 Customer Engagement (D365CE)
Team Composition	D365FO Functional Consultants, D365FO Technical Consultants, Azure Data Engineer, Data Migration Consultant	D365CE Technical Consultants, D365CE Technical Architects
Scope	Finance, Supply Chain, Human Resources, and Payroll integration	Contact Centre and self-service Portals for students, parents, and teachers
Primary Outcome	Unified back-office operations and workforce management across the school network	Consistent, digital-first engagement experience for the GEMS community

Both workstreams were architected to complement one another – sharing common master data, identity, and integration patterns – ensuring GEMS Education's back-office operations and front-facing digital experience evolved as part of a single coherent platform rather than two disconnected initiatives.

Our Team's Scope: D365FO, Human Resources & Payroll

Team Composition

- **D365FO Functional Consultants** – Led business process design, fit-gap analysis, and configuration across Finance, Supply Chain, and Human Resources modules.
- **D365FO Technical Consultants** – Delivered custom extensions, integrations, and technical configuration to support GEMS-specific business requirements within the D365FO platform.
- **Azure Data Engineer** – Designed and built the data pipeline architecture for legacy system extraction, transformation, and integration between D365FO, the payroll solution, and adjacent systems.
- **Data Migration Consultant** – Owned the end-to-end data migration strategy – master data, transactional data, and historical records – from legacy systems into D365FO.

Scope of Delivery

- **Finance & Operations Core** – Implemented General Ledger, Accounts Payable, Accounts Receivable, Fixed Assets, and Budgeting to support multi-entity financial consolidation across the GEMS school network.
- **Supply Chain Management** – Configured Procurement and Sourcing, Inventory Management, and Warehouse processes to standardise supply chain operations across schools.
- **Human Resources** – Implemented the D365 Human Resources module to centralise employee records, organisational structure, position management, and employee lifecycle processes (onboarding, transfers, offboarding) across the GEMS workforce.

- **Payroll Integration** – Designed and delivered the integration between D365 Human Resources and the organisation's payroll solution, ensuring accurate, timely synchronisation of employee master data, compensation changes, and organisational updates into payroll processing – reducing manual data entry and payroll error risk.
- **Data Migration** – Migrated legacy financial, HR, and master data into D365FO with a structured, validated approach – including data cleansing, mapping, reconciliation, and cutover planning.

Our Approach

Phase	Activities
Discovery & Design	Fit-gap analysis across Finance, Supply Chain, and HR processes specific to a multi-school education group; functional design documentation for payroll integration requirements
Build & Configure	D365FO module configuration, custom technical extensions, Azure-based data pipelines for HR-to-payroll integration, security role design aligned to school-level segregation of duties
Data Migration	Legacy data extraction, cleansing, mapping, and validation; phased migration approach with reconciliation checkpoints for financial and employee master data
Testing & Validation	Unit testing, system integration testing across D365FO–payroll interfaces, and user acceptance testing with GEMS finance, HR, and school operations stakeholders
Cutover & Go-Live	Phased cutover planning, parallel payroll runs for validation, and hypercare support across go-live windows
Stabilisation	Post-go-live monitoring of payroll integration accuracy, financial close support, and knowledge transfer to GEMS internal teams

Complementary Program: D365CE Contact Centre & Portals

Delivered in parallel by a dedicated D365CE team – comprising D365CE Technical Consultants and D365CE Technical Architects – this workstream focused on transforming how GEMS Education engages with its community:

- **Contact Centre** – A unified contact centre solution enabling consistent, trackable communication with students, parents, and teachers across the school network.
- **Student, Parent & Teacher Portals** – Self-service digital portals giving students, parents, and teachers a single point of access for enquiries, requests, and information relevant to their school journey.
- **Platform Alignment** – The D365CE solution was architected to align with the D365FO platform, supporting a consistent data and identity foundation across both back-office and front-facing systems.

Outcomes & Business Impact

Replace the placeholders below with confirmed program metrics once available.

Area	Impact
Financial Consolidation	[X]% faster month-end close across the school network
HR & Payroll Accuracy	[X]% reduction in payroll processing errors following automated HR-to-payroll integration
Process Efficiency	[X]% reduction in manual data entry across HR and finance operations
Data Migration	[X] legacy data objects migrated with [X]% reconciliation accuracy
Scalability	Platform foundation supporting onboarding of [X] additional schools without re-architecture
Stakeholder Experience	Unified digital engagement channel adopted by [X]K+ parents, students, and teachers via the new portals

Why It Mattered

For an organisation operating at the scale of GEMS Education, the value of this transformation extended beyond system modernisation. By unifying Finance, Supply Chain, HR, and Payroll on a single platform — and aligning that platform with a parallel investment in community-facing digital experience — GEMS Education established a scalable operational foundation capable of supporting continued growth across its global school network, while improving accuracy, transparency, and trust in core people and finance processes.

This case study reflects a program delivered for GEMS Education. Specific figures are placeholders pending confirmation and client approval prior to external publication.